



Northern Berkshire Astronomical Society

Whatever your experience, you belong under our skies

Founded 2023

<https://nbasastro.org/>

Volume 3, Issue 9



nbasastro.org

THE MOON

- Jun 8: Last Qtr
- Jun 15: New Moon
- Jun 21: First Qtr
- Jun 29: Strawberry Moon

PLANETS

Mercury: sets in evening twilight

Venus: in Tau, sets ~10:30 PM

Mars: in Ari, rises AM twilight

Jupiter: in Gem, sets ~10:30 PM

Saturn: in Psc, rises ~2:30 AM

Uranus: almost behind the Sun

Neptune: in Psc, rises ~1:30 AM

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

Challenges:

C 6, NGC 5897, M 102

Easy (Binoc.):

M 13, M 4, M 5

Moderate (Small Tel.):

M 51, M 92, M 57

INTERACTING

Check out our Facebook Group
facebook.com/groups/nberkastro

The Club is Moving Forward!

At our last meeting, we elected officers, formalized our bylaws, and discussed plans for the rest of the year:

Officers:

- President: Kevin Marsh
- Vice-President: Gareth Williams
- Treasurer: Debbie Pavin
- Secretary: Bob Donahue

Our Website Has Launched!

JUPITER — GREAT RED SPOT

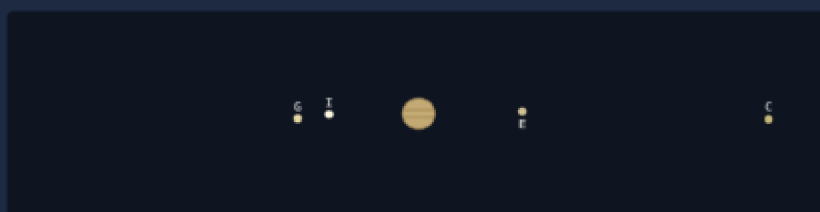


Upcoming GRS Transits

Shown when Jupiter is above horizon and sky is darker than nautical twilight. Accuracy ± 10 min.

Date	Time (local)	Jupiter Alt
May 16	10:01 PM	22.3°
May 18	11:38 PM	3.8°

JUPITER SYSTEM



Label above: moon is behind the planet. Label below: moon is in front.

We're really excited to announce our new website:

<https://nbasastro.org> and hope it can be a regional "point of presence" for astronomy and educational outreach! The site offers:

- Articles spanning the cosmos from asteroids in the Solar System, to supernovae in distant galaxies;
- Tools to help you plan your night time observing;
- Several ongoing series including "Planet Watch!", quizzes, and observing challenges!

Our “Solar System Dashboard” has timely information on:

- The locations of the Sun, Moon, and Planets;
- Renderings showing the phases of the inner planets, and features on Mars;
- Timings to see Jupiter’s Great Red Spot;
- The orientation of the satellite systems of Jupiter and Saturn, and
- Keeping tabs on upcoming (hopefully) bright comets.

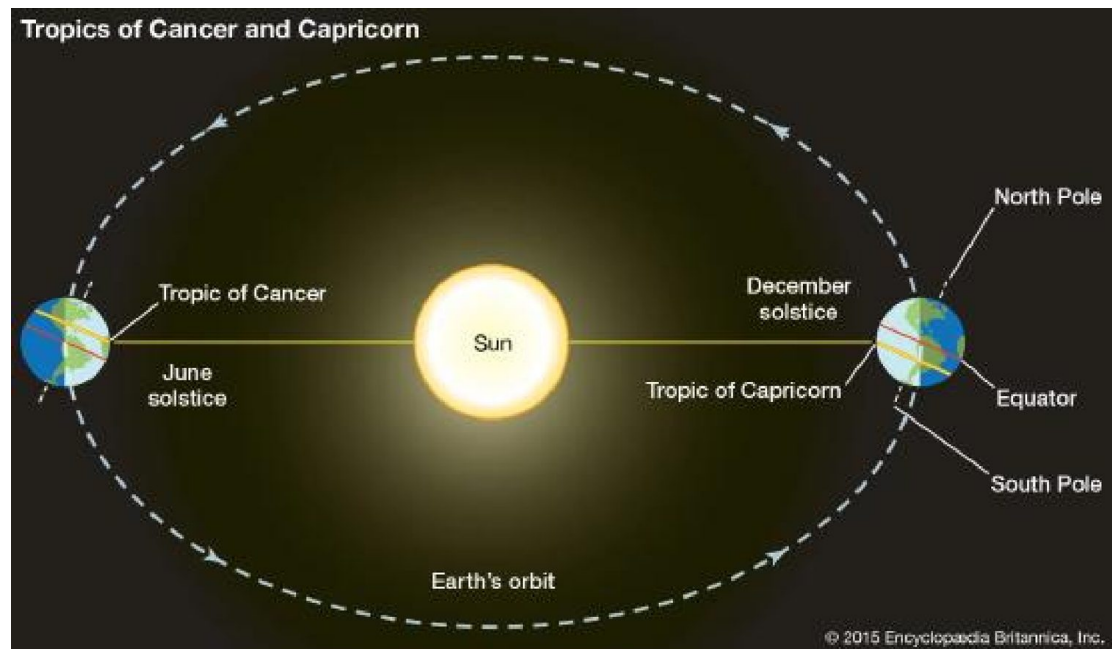
And there’s even more - on the site you can find:

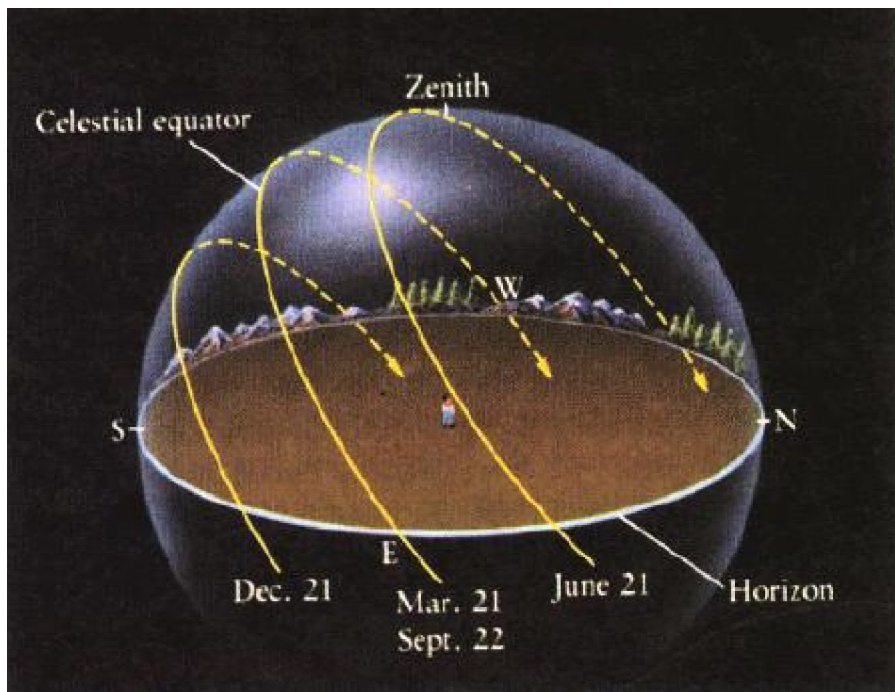
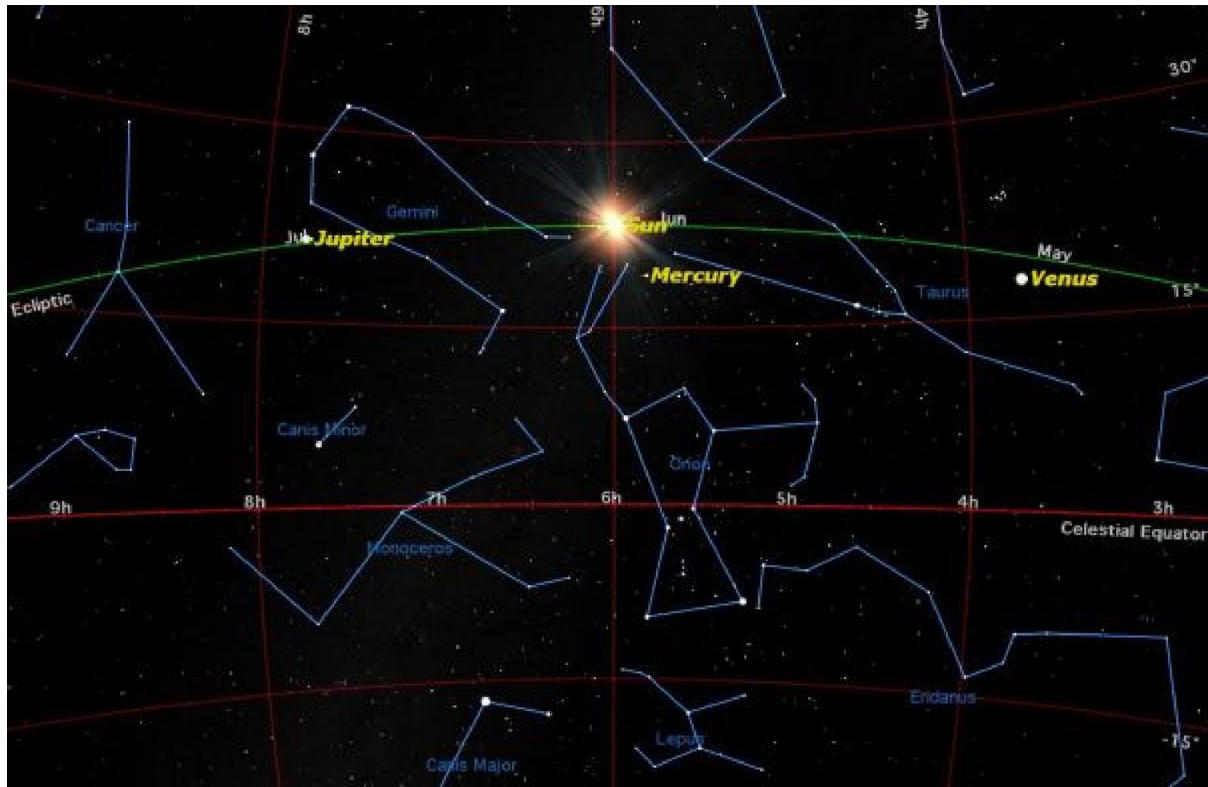
- The current view of the constellations;
- Up-to-date observing/weather conditions;
- Upcoming passages of the International Space Station;
- Aurora forecasting

Plus there’s NBAS calendar, with almanac, and regional events (if you know of any we should know about - let us know!)

☀ Summer Solstice

June 21st the Summer Solstice, when Sun reaches its maximum northern declination (in Gemini). Nights are short (just under 9 hours) with even more limited “dark time” (just over 4 hours).





This is caused by the Earth's axial tilt ($23\frac{1}{2}^{\circ}$) - at summer solstice the North Pole is pointed in the direction of the Sun's position: people above the Arctic Circle experience 24-hour days for several weeks on either side of the Solstice. The reverse is true for the Southern Hemisphere Antarctica: our Summer Solstice is their Winter Solstice, and in Antarctica, 24 hours of darkness.

This Month's Image



Bob Donahue, NBAS

The Lagoon Nebula in Sagittarius is one of the brighter emission nebulae, is dimly viewable in very dark skies with the naked eye. In binoculars, it appears as a greyish cloud-like patch with a brighter center. Inside is the loose open cluster NGC 6550, and has a great deal of structure shaped by winds from the hot young stars forming there.

This stellar nursery is fairly large - spanning 110 x 50 light years and is ~5,000 light years away.

Monthly Starmap

 For June's star chart, visit nbasastro.org/starmap/ (this week, with planets) or nbasastro.org/starmap/reference/ (any night, any year, no planets).